

Mercury HT 5800R Home Theatre 5.1 Channel System

Drowning in sound

Though this 5.1 channel system has a 5,800 watts PMPO, it has only 25 watts RMS for the satellites and 50 watts RMS for the subwoofer. The RMS power gives you an idea about the actual sound



output that the system can achieve without distortion, whereas the PMPO output indicates the maximum output achievable by the system, albeit with distortions.

The wires are long enough, and speaker stands and wall mountings are provided as well. One shortcoming is the ridiculously short power supply wire.

The system provides good performance and at Rs 7,000,

it offers good value for money. The subwoofer is quite powerful and you can crank up the volume without experiencing too much distortion. If you're looking to own a 5.1 speaker system, but are

constrained by your budget, the Mercury HT 5800R offers a decent enough solution. However, if you cannot settle for anything less than perfect sound, give this one a miss.

SPECIFICATIONS

Four satellites at 25 W RMS, one subwoofer at 50 W RMS, wall and stand mounts, remote control with batteries

System Requirements: Sound-card with 5.1 channel output

Price: Rs 7,000

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Seagate ST3120023A (120 GB Barracuda)

Speedy Gonzales

Seagate's 120 GB Barracuda hard disk supporting ATA V with a spindle speed of 7,200 rpm, has two platters of 60 GB each and four read/write heads, resulting in very quick retrieval of data. It sports a standard 2 MB buffer and uses Giant MagnetoResistive (GMR) recording heads, resulting in greater areal density, which makes larger disk sizes achievable.

The drive was tested on a Pentium 4-based test bench, with a 2.8 GHz CPU, Intel

D850 EMV2 motherboard with 256 MB RDRAM, and a GeForce4 Ti 4600 graphics accelerator. This drive gave us excellent results in the performance tests. It transferred 1 GB in a mere 57 seconds. The SiSoft Sandra 2002 Pro benchmark reported an average access time of 13.1 milliseconds, sequential read/write rates of 41/40 MBps, and random read/write speeds of 8/9 MBps, which is indeed very good. Photoshop 7.0 took a mere 12 seconds to load and



Mercury HT 5800R B	
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶
Build quality	▶▶▶▶▶
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶
Features	▶▶▶▶▶
OVERALL	▶▶▶▶▶

it opened a 190 MB image file in 14 seconds, which highlights the file transfer speed of the drive.

The disk took 14.2 seconds to load a saved game in *Return to Castle Wolfenstein*. This is especially good news for impatient gamers. There really aren't any drawbacks to this drive, except for perhaps its price. If you do not need the maximum storage space that money can buy, but you

Price: Rs 12,500

Contact: Seagate Technology

Phone: 1600 331104 (toll free)

Web site: www.seagate.com

Liteon LTR55246S

Not to be taken lightly

Liteon has introduced a new 52x Writer, the LTR55246S. It is surely one of the fastest writers/re-writers available today. In fact, in the Indian market, as of today, there are no CD-Rs that can support a writing speed of 52x. The maximum writing speed supported by media available today is 48x.

Its build quality is pretty average. A design on sturdier lines would have been appreciated. It has a standard 2,048 KB buffer. The buffer underrun prevention technology used by Liteon is SMART-BURN, which is also used for the optimisation of the CD burning process, to ensure that data is written accurately on to the CD-R/CD-RW.

The test was performed on a Pentium 4 2.2 GHz CPU, running on an MSI Max2 BLR motherboard, with 256 MB DDR RAM and a Radeon 8500 accelerator. In all of the tests,

do want all the speed you can get, then this is the drive for you. As far as storage goes, it sits smack in the middle of the gap between the low-end 40 to 80 GB dwarves and the top-end 160 to 200 GB giants.

SPECIFICATIONS

ATA V support, 7,200 rpm, 120 GB, 2 MB buffer

Seagate ST3120023A B+	
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶
Build quality	▶▶▶▶▶
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶
Features	▶▶▶▶▶
OVERALL	▶▶▶▶▶



the Writer performed at the maximum speed that the CD-R medium would allow. Nero CD Speed reported minimum, average and maximum speeds of 24.24x, 39.34x and 41.31x, respectively. There weren't any hitches at any stage of the other tests either, proving the quality and capability of the Writer.

What's more, at Rs 5,145, it's a pretty good deal as well. Considering it is one of the world's fastest writers, that's not a bad price at all. If you happen to have a raging fast machine that can support the data speeds required by this CD-Writer, then by all means, go for it.

SPECIFICATIONS

Write/re-write/read speed: 52x/24x/52x, 2,048 KB buffer, SMART-BURN technology for optimum writing, includes Nero - Burning ROM v 5.5.

Liteon LTR55246S B	
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶
Ease of use	▶▶▶▶▶
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶
Features	▶▶▶▶▶
OVERALL	▶▶▶▶▶

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